OFFICE OF
ASSESSOR-COUNTY CLERK-RECORDER & ELECTIONS
COUNTY OF SAN MATEO

MARK CHURCH
CHIEF ELECTIONS OFFICER &
ASSESSOR-COUNTY CLERK-RECORDER

Ballot Measure Primary Argument Submission Form

A ballot argument will not be accepted unless accompanied by this completed **typed** form, which shall contain the printed name(s) and signature(s) of the person(s) submitting it or, if submitted on behalf of a bona fide association of citizens, the name of the association and the printed name and signature of at least one of its principal officers.
Please make sure you are using proper format before submitting to the Elections Office.

Word count limit for Primary Arguments = 300 words

Ballot Measure _____ for the General Municipal Election to be held on Nov. 3, 2026.

☐ Primary Argument in Favor of ☑ Primary Argument Against

This argument is submitted by (check ONLY ONE):		
☐	**The County of San Mateo Board of Supervisors or the Governing Body of a School District or Special District**	
	Name of Governing Body:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Member(s) of the County of San Mateo Board of Supervisors or the Governing Body of a School District or Special District**	
	Name of Governing Body:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☑	**Bona Fide Association of Citizens** If this argument is filed by a bona fide association of citizens, the signers of the argument must be affiliated with the association and be authorized to sign the argument on its behalf. Provide the printed name and signature of at least one principal officer of the association.	
	Name of Association: Silicon Valley Taxpayers Association	
	Contact Person's Printed Name: Elizabeth C. Brierly	
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]
☐	**Individual Voters Eligible to Vote on the Measure**	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Combination of Voters and Associations**	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:

Arguments will be emailed to the contact person listed here for review before they are printed in the Sample Ballot & Official Voter Information Pamphlets.

Please complete the reverse side of this form.

40 Tower Road, San Mateo, CA 94402
P 650.312.5222 **F** 650.312.5348 **email** registrar@smcacre.gov **web** www.smcacre.gov

Primary Argument Signers Form			Author	Verified
No more than five signatures shall appear with any argument. If more than five signatures are submitted, the first five listed shall be printed. Names and titles listed will be printed in the order that they are listed below. Place a checkmark in the author column if the signer is the author of the argument. A signer can only list one title. Honorifics such as M.D., Dr., Esquire, etc. with a name are not accepted. If the signers are part of a bona fide association, there is no requirement that they be eligible to vote on the measure. However, for each such signing individual, the title under the signer's name must list the name of that bona fide association and may include their position within that association. By signing below, the undersigned state that they have read the argument and believe it not to be false or misleading. **Type** information clearly.			Check if the signer is the author of the argument. Authors must be signers.	(FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY) Staff check once the eligibility of the signer is verified.
1. Name: Elizabeth C. Brierly		Title: Director, Silicon Valley Taxpayers Association	☑	☐
Phone: [redacted]		Email: [redacted]		
Address: [redacted] San Jose, CA 95110			Pronouns:	
Signatu[redacted]		Date: Aug. 11, 2026	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☒ They/Them: ☐	
2. Name:		Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns:	
Signature:		Date:	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
3. Name:		Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns:	
Signature:		Date:	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
4. Name:		Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns:	
Signature:		Date:	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
5. Name:		Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns:	
Signature:		Date:	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	

Submit a second form (this side only) for alternate signers attached to this form and the argument.

Argument against Measure _ – Burlingame Hotel Tax Increase

[Argument starts here]

The Burlingame City Council expects voters to approve **a huge, 25 PERCENT tax hike** by saying residents won't have to pay.

But they want to dramatically increase the cost of visitors' coming here for business or pleasure.

Councilmembers are basically saying, **let's discourage people from visiting** and **spending their business dollars here**, and/or to **seeing us, their family and friends.** *Even when they're here to help while we're in the hospital!*

Does that make any sense?

Vote NO.

The ballot question says the tax would support "maintaining city streets/ sidewalks …repairing potholes," and "enhancing emergency response, preparedness …wildfire prevention…."

Which begs the question:

Why aren't such core services as police, pothole repair, and emergency response services fully covered by the budget?

Don't trust politicians!

Budgets demonstrate our representatives' priorities. Why the heck aren't those core services the highest priority, every day?

There's no guarantee the money would reach those services, anyway — because Measure_ actually proposes a "general government use" tax. So it could be diverted to literally anything the councilmembers pick.

Councilmembers should **safeguard, *in their regular budget,* our streets, sidewalks, and emergency response services.**

Don't we want ***more business*** from out-of-town visitors? ***more visits*** from loved ones?

It's common sense: Don't tax what you want more of!

Vote NO!

Send a message to councilmembers: *Don't treat vital core services as a mere afterthought, and penalize Burlingame's visitors to cover expenses you've overlooked!*

Vote *NO!*

Silicon Valley Taxpayers Association's volunteers advocate for taxpayers *throughout* Santa Clara County. Visit *SVtaxpayers.org*.

[Argument ends here]

RECEIVED
AUG 07 2026
CITY CLERK'S OFFICE
CITY OF BURLINGAME

[redacted]

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